

Claude interview

Thematic Analysis

Theme 1 — Factors influencing food choices · 56 codes · 5 sub-themes

Restaurant familiarity and trust

Users rely heavily on prior experience with and knowledge of a restaurant — its menu, pricing, delivery time, and reputation — as a primary decision-making shortcut.

Familiarity with restaurant8

Restaurant ratings and trust5

Habitual ordering patterns4

Favourite restaurant unavailable1

4 codes · 18 instances

Price sensitivity and deals

Cost is a core filter — users actively seek affordable options, good combos, and available discounts before committing to an order.

Affordability / value for money7

Discounts and offers3

2 codes · 10 instances

Appetite and personal food preferences

In-the-moment cravings, taste preferences, and nutritional considerations (protein, serving size) drive what users specifically choose to eat.

Craving a specific food item6

Taste / liking for food item or restaurant6

Protein content / nutritional value2

Serving size and fullness1

Perceived quality of food1

Wanting to try something new1

Felt like eating something unhealthy for cheat day1

7 codes · 18 instances

Proximity & delivery

Proximity of the restaurant, speed of delivery, and ease of the ordering process are key practical factors that shape food choices.

Proximity / quick delivery⁴

Availability of add-on beverages¹

Service quality¹

3 codes · 6 instances

AI interface as a decision aid

The AI ordering experience itself — through suggestions, item discoverability, and transparent pricing — nudged users toward food they might not have otherwise chosen.

AI-assisted ordering experience (positive)³

Clear categorisation / discoverability of food items²

2 codes · 5 instances

Theme 2- Factors influencing platform choice · 132 codes · 5 sub-themes

Speed and interaction efficiency

How fast and effortlessly a platform lets users place an order is the biggest driver of platform choice — both friction (too much back and forth) and delight (minimal effort ordering) cluster here.

Back-and-forth conversation feels tedious / slow¹⁵

Positive: efficiency / minimal effort ordering¹⁴

AI used only when food choice is certain⁹

Would use Swiggy for browsing; AI for execution³

Voice-based ordering preferred¹

5 codes · 42 instances

Interface format and output readability

Users have strong preferences about how information is presented — visuals vs text, tabular vs paragraph, clickable options vs typing — and these preferences heavily shape platform satisfaction.

Lack of food images reduces reliability / exploration¹⁰

Text-heavy / monotonous output format⁹

Prefer clicking / predefined options over typing⁵

Positive: structured / tabular output format⁶

Likes Claude's interface / visuals / colors6

5 codes · 36 instances

Degree of information completeness and transparency updated

Users expect platforms to proactively surface all relevant details — order summaries, delivery info, offer application, payment options — and the degree to which this is done shapes confidence and platform preference.

Missing or unclear key information11

Positive: transparency / chain-of-thought visibility6

Lack of payment options / offer clarity5

Trust / skepticism around AI accuracy5

Needs detailed menu when undecided4

Gravity of bill amount not felt1

Curiosity about token / credit usage2

7 codes · 34 instances

Personalisation and conversational quality

Users value platforms that feel human, understand context (hunger urgency, budget, taste), and make proactive suggestions — the emotional and conversational quality of the interaction matters.

Positive: personalised / human-feeling interaction9

Positive: good recommendations / location context7

Too many / too few options shown3

Takes user constraints well into consideration1

4 codes · 20 instances

User intent and context of use

The choice of platform depends strongly on the user's state — whether they already know what they want, how much time they have, and whether they're exploring or executing a known order.

AI used only when food choice is certain9

Would use Swiggy for browsing; AI for execution3

2 codes · 12 instances

Theme 3 — platform influence on food choice · 48 codes · 4 sub-themes

Absence of food visuals limits exploration and reinforces familiar choices

Without food images, users cannot visualise what they are ordering — this creates uncertainty that pushes them toward known, familiar items and actively discourages discovery of new restaurants or dishes.

Lack of food images hinders decision-making and exploration¹¹

No visual representation of quantity ordered¹

2 codes · 12 instances

Clarity and structure of information drives or blocks food selection

When platforms present information clearly — through structured tables, delivery times, nutritional details, and visible offers — users feel confident enough to select. When they don't, decision-making stalls or defaults to the familiar.

Positive: tabular / scannable format aids decision-making⁵

Missing food description / key info in suggestions⁵

Transparent and clear information eased selection⁵

Tags like "Recommended" / "Latest Deals" feel more intuitive¹

Positive: delivery time mentioned upfront¹

Bill amount gravity not felt in chatbot context¹

6 codes · 18 instances

Explorability and recommendation quality

Platforms influence whether users stick to familiar choices or explore new ones — poor browsability, unfamiliar restaurant suggestions, and weak alternatives when items are unavailable all push users toward safe, known options.

Unfamiliar restaurants feel unreliable⁵

Low browsability / overwhelming or too few suggestions⁴

Poor alternative suggestions when item unavailable³

Positive: platform recommended the item¹

4 codes · 13 instances

Helpful platform interventions steer users toward easier food decisions

When platforms proactively suggest add-ons, offer alternatives for unavailable items, or respond in a human-feeling way, they reduce decision effort and guide users toward choices they may not have arrived at independently.

Positive: add-on suggestions were helpful²

Positive: fast ordering without scrolling²

Positive: helpful alternative suggested when item unavailable¹

Positive: human-feeling interaction¹

4 codes · 6 instances

Chatgpt interview

Thematic Analysis

Theme 1- factors influencing users' food choices

Price Sensitivity and Deals

12 codes

Users are strongly driven by whether the food and delivery feel worth the money. Price visibility, affordability, and available discounts all act as gatekeepers before an order is placed.

Price / affordability of food item n = 10

Discounts and deals availability n = 2

Proximity & Delivery Convenience

13 codes

Nearness of the restaurant signals freshness and speed. Delivery time and charges are weighed alongside distance — together these form a 'convenience cost' in the user's mind.

Proximity / nearness of restaurant n=8

Delivery speed / time n=5

Restaurant Familiarity & Habit

17 codes

A large portion of food decisions are low-effort and automatic — users reorder from known restaurants or reach for the same dish out of habit, taste memory, or brand trust.

Habitual / repeat ordering n = 7

Familiarity with restaurant n = 7

Restaurant name / brand recognition n = 3

Variety of options available n = 2

Ratings and reviews influence choice n = 4

Craving and Personal food preference

15 codes

In-the-moment desire often overrides rational factors. Cravings, taste preferences, and specific flavour inclinations drive the choice before any other consideration.

Craving for the food item n= 6

Flavour / taste preference n = 6

Low-risk / safe food choice n = 3

Dietary preference (veg / non-veg) n = 6

Health consciousness n= 4

Ratings and reviews influence choice n= 4 Quality and quantity of food n = 3

Quality of AI suggestions

2 codes

A small but notable group flagged that the AI ordering experience introduced friction — feeling pushy, misunderstanding their need, or making the process harder.

AI felt pushy during ordering n = 2

Recommendations / second opinions n = 2

Theme 2- factors influencing users' platform of choice (swiggy ui, claude, chatgpt)

Ease of interaction and visual design clarity

30 codes

The dominant theme in platform choice. Users strongly prefer clickable, image-rich interfaces over text-heavy chat. Typing feels effortful; visuals aid trust, speed, and decision-making.

Preference for visuals / images over text n = 18

Animations and UI aesthetics n = 7

Quick ordering process appreciated n = 5

Pricing & Cost Transparency

16 codes

Users expect the platform to clearly show item prices, delivery charges, and totals at every step. Hidden or vague pricing creates friction and erodes trust.

Price / cost transparency n = 11

Offers / coupons not handled well by AI n = 3

Payment options lacking n = 2

Lack of trust on AI action and order confirmation

15 codes

Users need to feel certain that the platform understood their order and that it will be executed correctly. Confirmation ambiguity, opaque system states, and fear of mistakes undermine this trust.

Order confirmation confusion / trust in action n = 8

System status / transparency lacking n = 5

Trust issues with AI for order accuracy n = 2

AI Proactiveness & Conversational Quality

11 codes

Users who enjoyed AI ordering highlighted its proactive, conversational nature. However, this flips negative when AI over-directs or fails to understand context.

Proactiveness of AI appreciated n = 7

AI being pushy / over-directing n = 4

Information Quality & Structure

20 codes

Whether the information provided is accurate, well-organised, and appropriately detailed matters a lot. Users dislike both information overload and insufficient detail.

Information structure / clarity n = 7

AI suggestions unclear / low quality / irrelevant n = 9

Nutritional / calorie info n = 4

User intent and context of use

13 codes

AI tools are seen as situational — best when the user already knows what they want. When exploring or comparing, the Swiggy app's structured UI is preferred.

AI preferred only when order already decided $n = 7$

Too many / too few options provided $n = 5$

Location / delivery context missing $n = 1$

Theme 3- Platform influence on users food choice

Absence of Food Visuals Limits Exploration & Undermines Food Trust

13 codes

Across all platforms, the presence or absence of food images was the single biggest factor shaping what users chose to order. Without images, users defaulted to familiar, low-risk items.

Lack of food images reduces trust and decision-making $n = 10$

Defaults to familiar / low-risk food without images $n = 2$

Proactive AI Suggestions Guide & Simplify Food Choice

20 codes

When the platform made proactive, contextually relevant suggestions, users followed them — even for unknown restaurants or new items. Poor or irrelevant suggestions had the opposite effect.

AI / chatbot suggestions made decision easy $n = 12$

Suggestions aligned with hunger / context $n = 3$

AI comparison of options lacking $n = 3$

ChatGPT offered more options than Claude $n = 2$

Lack of Menu Completeness & Offer Visibility

9 codes

Incomplete menus and hidden offers narrowed users' choices artificially. Users noticed when bestseller bias limited what they could see and felt they may have missed better options.

Menu incomplete / not fully shown n = 6

Offers not visible on platform n = 3

Add-on Suggestions Enhance Order Experience

6 codes

Personalised nudges like add-on suggestions or beverage pairings were positively received and influenced final order composition, making the experience feel tailored.

Add-on / upsell suggestions appreciated n = 3

Suggestion of unknown restaurant / food item n = 3

Interface Complexity & Its Effect on Ordering Ease mixed

7 codes

How much the interface asks of the user directly shapes the ordering experience. When the platform kept things simple — fewer options, no clutter, no manual comparisons — ordering felt effortless. But when the interface failed to retrieve familiar orders or broke expected flows, it created friction and distrust.

Simplified interface reduces cognitive load positive n = 4

Interface failure disrupts familiar order flow negative n = 1

Exploration of new places not possible negative n = 1

Swiggy interview

Thematic Analysis

Theme 1- Factors influencing food choices 132 codes · 5 sub-themes

T1.1 — Price sensitivity and deal

40 codes

Users are strongly driven by cost — from base price and delivery charges to deals, combos, and offer-stacking. Value for money and budget constraints shape most ordering decisions.

Affordability / value for money 18

Discounts, offers, and deals 9

Combo meal / filling meal preference 7

Low delivery charges 2

Budget 2

T1.2 — Proximity & delivery

17 codes

Proximity of the restaurant and estimated delivery time are major filters. Users frequently prioritise getting food quickly, especially when hungry, over other considerations.

Preference for nearby / fast-delivery restaurants 14

First available option chosen 3

T1.3 — Appetite and personal food preferences

33 codes

In-the-moment cravings, taste and dietary preferences, and nutritional considerations (protein, serving size) drive what users specifically choose to eat.

Personal liking / craving for food item 12

Dietary preference (veg / non-veg) 3

Exploration / trying new restaurants 7

Calorie count awareness 2

Hunger level 5

Ease of eating in public 1

Protein content / health-conscious eating 9

Calorie count awareness 2

T1.4 — Visual appeal

13 codes

The appearance of food and restaurants in images creates real-life expectations that significantly influence choices.

Visually appealing food image 7

quality perception with image 1

attracted to visually tempting unfamiliar restaurant 1

T1.5 — Restaurant familiarity and trust.

Users also rely on prior experience and knowledge of a restaurant — its menu, pricing, delivery time, and reputation — as a decision-making marker.

Familiarity with restaurant / prior experience 9

Trust in brand 3

Restaurant rating 5

Theme 2 — Factors influencing platform choice 73 codes · 5 sub-themes

T2.1 — Trust and familiarity with Swiggy UI

18 codes

Users default to Swiggy UI because they know it well — its interface, reliability, customer support, and track record make it feel safe and effortless.

Familiarity and trust in Swiggy UI 8

Heavy Swiggy usage / positive experience 2

Customer care / helpline availability 2

Swiggy preferred for browsing and exploration 5

Ease of navigating menu / app browsing 3

T2.2 — Visual and information clarity

19 codes

Swiggy's food images, clear pricing, restaurant distance, and menu detail reduce cognitive load and help users make faster, more confident choices compared to text-only platforms.

Visuals / food images aid decision-making 6

Clarity of information on Swiggy 4

Ease of use / intuitive interface 5

Likes detailed restaurant menu 2

T2.3 — Offers and promotional influence

7 codes

Swiggy's deals, notifications, and promotional UI actively pull users back to the platform — sometimes helpfully, sometimes causing distraction from their original intent.

Offers and discounts on Swiggy attract users 5

Swiggy can distract from original goal 2

T2.4 — Cognitive overload and friction

17 codes

Despite Swiggy's strengths, users report frustration with excessive ads, overwhelming options, unhelpful filters, high platform fees, and a lack of personalisation that slows decision-making.

Too many options / offers cause confusion 5

Ads / pop-ups are annoying or distracting 5

Filters and search helpful (or not) 5

Platform charges are high 2

Difficulty in differentiating food items 3

T2.5 — Personalisation and health features

9 codes

Users desire platforms that adapt to their dietary needs and show nutritional data — Swiggy currently falls short here, which affects satisfaction and platform loyalty among health-conscious users.

Personalisation / recommendation missing 5

Nutritional / macro data desired on platform 4

Theme 3 — How platform influences food choice 53 codes · 4 sub-themes

T3.1 — Visual persuasion

16 codes

Food images are the most powerful platform-driven influence on what users ultimately order. Photos set quality expectations, trigger appetite, and make choices feel concrete and trustworthy.

Food images influence ordering decisions 9

Catchy UI / gamification influences impulse choices 4

Scrolling / browsing all options before deciding 2

Liked "guilt-free" section but options unappealing 1

T3.2 — Promotional nudges and social proof

19 codes

Offers, deal banners, "bestseller" and "favourites" tags, and upsell suggestions in cart actively redirect users away from their original intent — sometimes positively, sometimes frustratingly.

Offers / discounts influence choices 7

Social proof tags build trust 5

Add-ons / upsell suggestions from UI 3

Delivery time / distance notifications influence choice 2

T3.3 — Navigation and menu structure

12 codes

How menus are organised — sections, groupings, and search/filter tools — directly affects how confidently users choose. Poor structure causes scanning fatigue; good structure accelerates decisions.

Menu structure / navigation ease 6

Search bar / filters speed up decision-making 6

Extra charges more visible in Swiggy UI 1

Macro / nutritional breakdown helpful 2

T3.4 — Choice overload and decision fatigue

5 codes

When options look too similar — in image or description — users struggle to decide. The platform's inability to meaningfully differentiate items leads to frustration and sometimes abandoned choices.

Decision fatigue from too many similar options 5